

Absolutely — **slow** is a strong target because your passage uses it inside:

> “gardening gives her a chance to **slow down** and breathe.”

Here **slow** expresses **reducing speed or pace**, but the word also covers physical speed, rate of change, response/reaction, business periods, mental processing, technology, clocks, cooking, and several related forms such as **slowly, slowness, slowdown**.

Word family: **slow / slower / slowest / slowly / slowness / slowdown**

Base word: slow

Comparative: slower

Superlative: slowest

Related forms: slowly, slowness

Useful lexical extension: slowdown

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / adverb (副詞 , 某些固定口語用法) / verb (動詞)

Your sentence:

> “She has a busy job, and gardening gives her a chance to **slow down** and breathe.”

Meaning in your passage: **slow down** = reduce pace / become less hurried — 放慢腳步；慢下來

Here **slow** does not simply mean “move physically at a low speed.”

It means:

> **to reduce the pace of activity and stop being so rushed or busy.**

繁體中文：

降低生活 / 活動節奏，不再那麼匆忙；放慢腳步

Natural translation:

> “Gardening gives her a chance to slow down and breathe.”

「做園藝讓她有機會**放慢腳步，喘一口氣**。」

So here:

> **slow down** = 放慢生活 / 活動節奏

1. **slow** = moving at low speed (移動) — 慢的 ; 速度低的

The basic physical meaning.

Practice 1

> “The bus was very **slow** in the heavy traffic.”

「交通擠塞時，那輛巴士行駛得很**慢**。」

Practice 2

> “A slow train takes nearly twice as long.”

「較**慢**的**火車**幾乎要花兩倍時間。」

slow = 移動速度低，完成一段距離所需時間較長

2. **slow** = taking a long time (過程) — 緩慢的 ; 費時的

This broadens from movement to any process.

Practice 3

> “Plant growth is **slow** during winter.”

「植物在冬季生長得很**緩慢**。」

Practice 4

> “Recovery after the injury was slow.”

「受傷後的康復過程很**緩慢**。」

slow = 某個過程、變化或進展需要較長時間才完成

3. **slow** = happening at a low rate (速度 / 頻率) — 緩慢的 ; 增長不快的

Common with rates, growth, progress, change, etc.

Practice 5

> “The company experienced **slow growth**.”

「公司經歷了**緩慢增長**。」

Practice 6

> “There has been a slow decline in demand.”

「需求一直在**緩慢下降**。」

slow = 數量、程度或狀況的變化速率較低

4. **slow** = not busy / having little activity (商業 / 場所) — 清淡的；不忙的；生意較少的

A common business/service meaning.

Practice 7

> “Tuesday is usually a **slow day** for the restaurant.”

「星期二通常是餐廳**生意較淡**的一天。」

Practice 8

> “Business has been slow this month.”

「這個月**生意比較淡**。」

slow — business = 顧客、訂單、交易或活動量較少

This is not about literal movement speed.

5. **slow** = taking a long time to respond/react (反應) — 反應慢的；遲緩的

Practice 9

> “The computer is very **slow** today.”

「今天這部電腦**反應很慢**。」

Practice 10

> “He was slow to respond to the question.”

「他對那個問題**反應得比較慢 / 遲了一會才回答**。」

slow = 對刺激、要求或指令作出反應所需時間較長

6. **slow to + verb (做事較慢 / 遲遲不.....) — 遲遲不；不很快去.....**

A very useful construction.

Practice 11

> “The company was **slow to react** to the complaints.”

「公司對投訴**反應遲緩 / 遲遲沒有作出回應**。」

Practice 12

> “She was slow to trust new people.”

「她**不會很快信任陌生人**。」

slow to do something = 不很快作出某個行動、反應或改變

This may imply:

- * physical delay;
- * caution;
- * reluctance;
- * naturally slow response.

Context decides.

7. **slow = having difficulty learning/understanding (學習；較舊 / 敏感) — 理解較慢的；學習較慢的**

This exists, but needs careful register handling.

Practice 13

> “He was sometimes **slow to understand** new instructions.”

「他有些理解新指示會**比較慢**。」

Practice 14

> “Some students learn more slowly than others.”

「有些學生的學習速度比其他人**慢一些**。」

****slow — cognition = 理解或學習某些內容需要較多時間****

Important usage note:

Calling a person simply:

> “He is slow.”

to mean intellectually limited can sound ****insulting or outdated****.

Better:

* slow to understand

* learns more slowly

* needs more time to process information

8. ****slow = delayed / behind schedule (服務 / 交通) — 延誤的 ; 進展慢的****

Practice 15

> “Traffic was ****slow**** because of roadworks.”

「由於道路工程，交通**行進緩慢**。」

Practice 16

> “Service was unusually slow.”

「服務今天異常**緩慢 / 上菜很慢**。」

****slow = 某項服務、流程或交通沒有以正常預期速度進行****

9. ****slow = low-speed internet/system (科技) — 運作慢的 ; 速度低的****

A very common modern use.

Practice 17

> “The internet connection is too **slow**.”

「網絡連線速度太**慢**。」

Practice 18

> “The app becomes slow when too many files are open.”

「開啟太多檔案時，這個應用程式會變得**反應很慢**。」

slow — technology = 資料傳輸、處理或反應速度較低

This is a contextual extension of low processing rate.

10. **slow = clock/watch losing time (鐘錶) — 慢了；走得慢**

Practice 19

> “My watch is five minutes **slow**.”

「我的手錶**慢了五分鐘**。」

Practice 20

> “That clock runs slightly slow.”

「那個鐘**走得稍微慢了一點**。」

be X minutes slow = 顯示的時間比正確時間落後 X 分鐘

Important contrast:

> five minutes slow = 慢五分鐘

> five minutes fast = 快五分鐘

11. **slow = requiring low speed / gentle cooking (烹飪) — 慢火的；慢煮的**

Practice 21

> “Cook the meat over a **slow heat**.”

「用**慢火 / 小火**煮肉。」

Practice 22

> “Slow cooking makes the meat more tender.”

「**慢煮**可以令肉更嫩。」

slow — cooking = 以較低溫度或較長時間烹煮

This gives:

* slow cooking

* slow cooker

* slow-roasted

12. **slow cooker (廚房) — 慢燉鍋 ; 慢煮鍋**

A common lexicalized compound.

Practice 23

> “She cooked the soup in a **slow cooker**.”

「她用**慢燉鍋**煮湯。」

Practice 24

> “A slow cooker is useful for meals that cook for several hours.”

「**慢煮鍋**適合需要煮幾個小時的菜式。」

slow cooker = 以較低溫度長時間烹煮食物的電器

13. **slow = not lively / calm in tempo (音樂 / 節奏) — 慢板的 ; 節奏慢的**

Practice 25

> “They danced to a **slow song**.”

「他們隨著一首**慢歌**跳舞。」

Practice 26

> “The piece begins with a slow rhythm.”

「這首樂曲以**緩慢節奏**開始。」

slow — music = 節拍 / 速度較低、較舒緩的

14. **slow = verb, make something move/progress less quickly — 使減慢；拖慢**

Now **slow** is a verb.

Practice 27

> “Heavy traffic **slowed** the bus.”

「繁忙交通**拖慢了**巴士。」

Practice 28

> “Lack of funding **slowed** the project.”

「資金不足**拖慢了**項目進度。」

slow + object = 使某人 / 某事的速度、進展或變化率下降

This can be physical or figurative.

15. **slow = become less fast (動詞) — 減慢；放慢**

Practice 29

> “The car **slowed** as it approached the corner.”

「汽車接近轉角時**減慢了**速度。」

Practice 30

> “Economic growth has slowed.”

「經濟增長已經**放緩**。」

slow — intransitive verb = 速度、增長或活動程度降低

16. **slow down (動詞) — 減速；放慢；放慢節奏**

Your source construction.

Because our normal rule excludes phrasal verbs, I would not create a huge separate phrasal-verb section, but this one is essential because it appears in the passage.

Practice 31 — Original

> “Gardening gives her a chance to **slow down**.”

「園藝讓她有機會**放慢腳步 / 放慢生活節奏**。」

Practice 32

> “You should slow down on wet roads.”

「在濕滑路面上你應該**減速**。」

Practice 33

> “I need to slow down and get more rest.”

「我需要**放慢生活節奏**，多休息一下。」

slow down = 使 / 變得沒有那麼快；也可指減少生活或工作的匆忙程度

17. **slowly = at a low speed/rate — 緩慢地；慢慢地**

The standard adverb.

Practice 34

> “The plant grew **slowly**.”

「這棵植物**慢慢地**生長。」

Practice 35

> “Please speak more slowly.”

「請說得**慢一點**。」

slowly = 以較低速度、速率或節奏進行

18. **slow as an adverb (口語 / 標示) — 慢慢地；減速**

Although **slowly** is the normal adverb, **slow** itself can act adverbially in some contexts.

Practice 36

> “Drive **slow**.”

「**慢駛**。」

Practice 37

> “Go slow near the school.”

「靠近學校時要**慢慢行駛 / 減速**。」

slow — adverbial = slowly , 主要見於口語、道路提示或固定表達

For formal writing:

> drive slowly

is generally safer.

19. **slowness = state/quality of being slow — 緩慢；遲緩**

Practice 38

> “The **slowness** of the system frustrated users.”

「系統的**反應遲緩**令使用者感到沮喪。」

Practice 39

> “They complained about the slowness of the service.”

「他們投訴服務**太慢 / 效率低**。」

slowness = 速度、反應或進展較慢的狀態

20. **slowdown = reduction in speed/activity/growth — 放緩；減速；衰退**

A major lexical extension.

Practice 40

> “The economy experienced a **slowdown**.”

「經濟出現**增長放緩**。」

Practice 41

> “There has been a slowdown in sales.”

「銷售增長出現**放緩 / 銷售活動減弱**。」

slowdown = 速度、活動量、增長率或生產程度下降

Very common in:

* economics

* business

* production

* traffic

21. **slow-moving (移動 / 進展) — 移動緩慢的；進展慢的**

A useful compound adjective.

Practice 42

> “We were stuck behind a **slow-moving vehicle**.”

「我們被一輛**行駛緩慢的車輛**擋住。」

Practice 43

> “It became a slow-moving investigation.”

「那宗調查變成了一項**進展緩慢的調查**。」

slow-moving = 移動或進展速度較低的

22. **slow-paced (生活 / 故事 / 工作) — 節奏緩慢的**

Practice 44

> “She prefers a **slow-paced lifestyle**.”

「她喜歡**節奏較慢的生活方式**。」

Practice 45

> “The film is deliberately slow-paced.”

「這部電影刻意採用**較慢的節奏**。」

slow-paced = 活動、敘事或生活進行節奏較緩慢的

This connects very closely with your source idea.

23. **slow motion (影像) — 慢動作；慢鏡頭**

A useful compound.

Practice 46

> “The replay showed the moment in **slow motion**.”

「重播以**慢動作 / 慢鏡頭**顯示那一刻。」

Practice 47

> “The camera can record in slow motion.”

「這部相機可以拍攝**慢動作影片**。」

****slow motion = 把動作以比實際速度更慢的方式播放 / 呈現****

24. ****slow lane (道路) — 慢車道****

Practice 48

> “The truck stayed in the ****slow lane****.”

「貨車一直行駛在****慢車道****。」

Practice 49

> “Move into the slow lane if you are driving more slowly.”

「如果車速較慢，就駛入****慢車道****。」

****slow lane = 供速度較慢車輛使用的車道****

Exact road rules vary by jurisdiction, so this is a vocabulary meaning, not driving advice.

Important distinction: ****slow vs slowly****

****slow****

usually adjective:

> “The car is slow.”

「這輛車很慢。」

****slowly****

standard adverb:

> “The car is moving slowly.”

「這輛車正在慢慢行駛。」

But informal/fixed:

> “Drive slow.”

is also possible.

For learners:

> **slow** = adjective

> **slowly** = standard adverb

is the safest core rule.

Important distinction: **slow** vs **late**

You already curated **late**.

slow

= something takes a long time / moves at low speed.

late

= something happens after the expected or scheduled time.

A train can be:

> **slow but on time**

or:

> **fast but late**

So they are not synonyms.

Important distinction: **slow** vs **delayed**

slow

the process itself moves/progresses slowly.

delayed

it starts/arrives later than planned.

> "The service is slow."

= 服務過程很慢。

> “The service was delayed.”

= 服務延遲開始 / 進行。

Important distinction: **slow vs gradual**

slow

emphasizes low speed/rate.

gradual

emphasizes change happening in small stages rather than suddenly.

> slow growth

> = 增長速度慢

> gradual growth

> = 增長逐步發生

Something can be both **slow and gradual**, but they are not identical.

Important distinction: **slow vs calm**

slow

= low pace/speed.

calm

= peaceful, not excited/agitated.

Your aunt may:

> slow down

and thereby feel:

> calm

But **slow** itself does not mean emotionally calm.

Important distinction: **slow vs lazy**

slow

= low speed.

lazy

= unwilling to work or make effort.

A slow worker may be careful, inexperienced, overloaded, or using a slow system. Calling them **lazy** adds a judgment about motivation.

So:

> slow $\neq$ lazy

Important distinction: **slow vs weak**

You already curated **weak**.

slow internet

= low transmission/response speed.

weak signal

= low signal strength.

A signal can be:

* strong but slow;

* weak but still relatively fast in some contexts.

Different dimensions.

Important distinction: **slow down vs stop**

slow down

= reduce speed.

stop

= reduce speed to zero / cease activity.

> “Slow down.”

= 慢一點。

> “Stop.”

= 停止。

Important distinction: **slow down vs unwind**

Your passage contains both ideas.

slow down

= reduce the pace of activity/life.

unwind

= relax mentally after stress/work.

Gardening may allow her to:

> **slow down**

> 「放慢腳步」

and then:

> **unwind**

> 「放鬆身心」

They overlap in context, but the core meanings differ.

Important distinction: **a slow day**

Depending on context:

Business

> “It’s a slow day.”

= 今天客人 / 生意很少。

General activity

= 今天事情不多、節奏清閒。

It does **not** necessarily mean the day literally passes more slowly.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

- * **slow** — physical speed = 慢的
- * **slow** — process = 緩慢的
- * **slow** — rate/change = 增長 / 變化速度低的
- * **slow** — business/activity = 生意清淡 / 活動不多
- * **slow** — reaction = 反應遲緩
- * **slow to do** = 遲遲不 / 不很快.....
- * **slow** — learning/processing = 理解 / 學習較慢
- * **slow** — service/traffic = 進行緩慢
- * **slow** — technology = 運作 / 反應慢
- * **clock is slow** = 鐘錶走慢
- * **slow** — cooking = 慢火 / 慢煮
- * **slow cooker** = 慢燉鍋
- * **slow** — music = 節奏慢
- * **slow** — transitive verb = 使減慢 / 拖慢
- * **slow** — intransitive verb = 減慢 / 放緩
- * **slow down** = 減速 / 放慢生活節奏
- * **slowly** = 緩慢地
- * **slow** — adverbial informal use = 慢慢地
- * **slowness** = 緩慢 / 遲緩
- * **slowdown** = 放緩 / 減速
- * **slow-moving** = 移動 / 進展緩慢的
- * **slow-paced** = 節奏緩慢的
- * **slow motion** = 慢動作
- * **slow lane** = 慢車道

I would stop here rather than force rare specialist senses.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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slow — movement	移動速度較低，完成一段距離需要較長時間
slow — process	某個過程或進展需要較長時間才能完成
slow — rate/change	數量、程度或狀況的變化速率較低
slow — business	顧客、訂單、交易或活動量較少
slow — response	作出反應或執行指令所需時間較長
slow to do	沒有很快作出某項行動、反應或改變
slow — learning/understanding	理解 / 處理資訊需要較多時間
slow — technology	資料傳輸、處理或系統反應速度較低
X minutes slow	鐘錶顯示時間比正確時間落後 X 分鐘
slow — cooking	以較低熱力或較長時間進行烹煮
slow — music	節拍、速度或節奏較低
slow — transitive verb	使某人 / 某事的速度、進展或變化率降低
slow — intransitive verb	自身速度、增長或活動程度降低
slow down	減少速度；亦指放慢生活 / 工作節奏
slowly	以較低速度、速率或節奏進行
slowness	速度、反應或進展較慢的狀態
slowdown	速度、活動量、增長率或生產程度下降
slow-moving	移動或進展速度較低的
slow-paced	生活、工作或敘事節奏較緩慢的
slow motion	把動作以低於實際速度的方式播放 / 呈現
slow lane	供速度較慢車輛行駛的車道

For your original sentence

> “She has a busy job, and gardening gives her a chance to ****slow down**** and breathe.”

The exact meaning is:

****slow down** = 暫時降低忙碌生活的節奏，不再那麼匆忙

So naturally:

> ****「她的工作很忙，而做園藝讓她有機會放慢腳步、喘一口氣。」****

The highest-value contrasts are:

> ****slow**** → 速度慢

> ****slow**** → 進展慢

- > ****slow business**** → 生意清淡
- > ****slow computer**** → 反應慢
- > ****clock is slow**** → 鐘錶走慢
- > ****slow something**** → 拖慢某事
- > ****slow down**** → 減速 / 放慢節奏
- > ****slowdown**** → 放緩 / 減速
- > ****slowly**** → 緩慢地